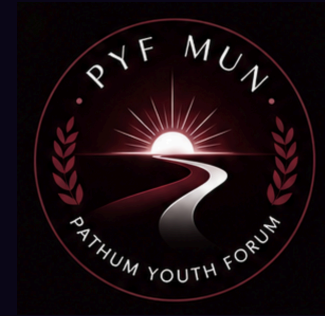




Pathum Youth Forum

Presents



PYF MUN 2026

"Your Pathway to the World of Diplomacy"

Beginner's Guide

PYF MODEL UNITED NATIONS 2026
23rd – 24th May 2026 | Online Conference
Your pathway into diplomacy, debate, and leadership.

About Pathum Youth Forum

Pathum Youth Forum is a youth-driven platform committed to fostering diplomacy, intellectual dialogue, leadership, and global awareness among students across diverse backgrounds. Founded with the vision of creating accessible opportunities for meaningful engagement, PYF aims to empower young individuals through conferences, discussions, simulations, and collaborative initiatives that encourage critical thinking and informed expression. At its core, Pathum Youth Forum believes that youth are not merely future leaders, but active contributors to present-day conversations shaping the world. Through its initiatives, PYF strives to cultivate confidence, analytical ability, diplomacy, and cross-cultural understanding while building a community where ideas are exchanged respectfully and perspectives are challenged constructively. By combining education with practical exposure, Pathum Youth Forum seeks to create experiences that inspire students to become responsible global citizens, effective communicators, and impactful leaders.



About PYFMUN'26

PYFMUN'26 is the flagship online Model United Nations conference of Pathum Youth Forum, designed to provide delegates with a platform for meaningful debate, diplomacy, and growth. With engaging agendas, experienced Executive Board members, and a balanced environment for both beginners and experienced participants, PYFMUN'26 aims to encourage critical thinking, confident expression, and impactful discussion on global issues.

A MESSAGE TO ALL FIRST-TIME DELEGATES

Welcome to PYFMUN 2026.

If this is your first Model United Nations conference, you may feel nervous, confused, or uncertain about what to expect. However, every experienced delegate once started exactly where you are today. MUN is not about knowing everything — it is about learning, improving, and growing through experience.

This Beginner's Guide has been carefully designed to help you understand the basics of Model United Nations in a simple, practical, and professional manner. The objective of this guide is not merely to help you win awards, but to help you develop essential life skills such as:

• Public Speaking • Research and Analysis • Negotiation • Diplomacy • Leadership • Teamwork • Confidence Building • Critical Thinking

At PYFMUN 2026, we encourage delegates to focus on meaningful participation, respectful diplomacy, and intellectual growth. Every speech you deliver, every alliance you build, and every solution you propose contributes to your journey as a future leader.

Remember: The true success of an MUN conference is not measured only through awards, but through the confidence, friendships, experiences, and knowledge you gain throughout the process.

We look forward to witnessing your diplomacy in committee.

INTRODUCTION TO THE UNITED NATIONS & MUN

WHAT IS THE UNITED NATIONS?

The United Nations (UN) is an international organization established in 1945 after the Second World War with the primary objective of maintaining international peace and security. Today, the United Nations consists of almost every sovereign nation in the world and serves as a global platform for dialogue, cooperation, and collective action. The main purposes of the United Nations include:

- Maintaining international peace and security.
- Promoting friendly relations among nations.
- Solving international economic, social, and humanitarian problems.
- Protecting human rights.
- Encouraging international cooperation.

WHAT IS MODEL UNITED NATIONS (MUN)?

Model United Nations is an academic simulation of the United Nations where students act as diplomats representing countries, organizations, political leaders, or international stakeholders.

In an MUN conference, delegates debate real-world global issues, negotiate with one another, draft resolutions, and attempt to create practical and diplomatic solutions.

The purpose of MUN is to simulate how international diplomacy functions in reality while helping students develop communication, analytical, and leadership skills.

WHY SHOULD YOU PARTICIPATE IN MUN?

WHY MUN MATTERS ?

Participating in Model United Nations offers much more than simply debating in committee. MUN provides students with practical exposure to diplomacy, international relations, and structured discussion.

Skills Developed Through MUN

Public Speaking

Delegates learn how to confidently express ideas before large audiences in a professional and diplomatic manner.

Research & Analysis

MUN encourages delegates to research global affairs, international conflicts, policies, treaties, and foreign relations in depth.

Negotiation & Diplomacy

Delegates learn how to negotiate respectfully, build alliances, and work collaboratively with other nations.

Leadership & Confidence

By speaking, drafting documents, and leading blocs, delegates gradually develop confidence and leadership qualities.

Critical Thinking

Delegates are trained to think logically, analyze multiple perspectives, and create realistic solutions.

Additional Benefits

- Networking opportunities.
- Exposure to global perspectives.
- Improved communication skills.
- Enhanced academic profile.
- Better understanding of world affairs.
- Preparation for careers in law, politics, diplomacy, journalism, and international relations.

MUN is both educational and transformative. The experience and confidence gained through conferences remain valuable throughout life.

WHO IS A DELEGATE?

UNDERSTANDING YOUR ROLE AS A DELEGATE

As a participant in PYFMUN 2026, you are known as a delegate.

A delegate is an individual who represents a country, organization, ministry, political leader, or stakeholder during committee proceedings. Your responsibility is not to express your personal opinion, but to represent the official stance and interests of your assigned portfolio.

Responsibilities of a Delegate

A delegate is expected to:

- Research their assigned portfolio thoroughly.
- Understand the agenda in detail.
- Speak diplomatically and professionally.
- Participate actively during debates.
- Collaborate with other delegates.
- Draft working papers and resolutions.
- Respect committee decorum and rules.

Speaking in Third Person

Delegates must always refer to themselves in third person.

For example: Rather than saying “I believe this policy should be changed.” you need to say “The Delegate of India believes this policy should be reconsidered.”

This style reflects diplomatic professionalism and mirrors actual international proceedings.

Remember: When committee begins, you are no longer speaking as yourself, you are speaking as the representative of your assigned portfolio.

UNDERSTANDING COMMITTEES

WHAT ARE COMMITTEES?

Committees are simulated bodies within the United Nations or other international organizations where delegates debate specific global issues.

Each committee has:

- A specific agenda.
- A unique format.
- Different rules and procedures.
- Distinct objectives and responsibilities.

Committees are designed to replicate real international forums and decision-making bodies.

COMMON TYPES OF COMMITTEES

UN Committees

These committees simulate official United Nations bodies and agencies.

Examples: • United Nations Security Council (UNSC) • United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC) • United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) • World Health Organization (WHO)

Crisis Committees

Fast-paced committees where delegates respond to rapidly changing situations, emergencies, or historical crises.

Historical Committees

Committees based on significant historical events where delegates attempt to alter or influence outcomes.

Press Corps

Participants act as journalists, photographers, or media correspondents who report committee developments.

Double Delegation Committees

Two delegates jointly represent one portfolio, requiring teamwork and coordination.

Each committee offers a different style of diplomacy and debate, making every MUN experience unique.

AGENDA, PORTFOLIO & EXECUTIVE BOARD

WHAT IS AN AGENDA?

An agenda refers to the issue or topic that the committee will discuss throughout the conference.

Examples: • Addressing Climate Change • Combating Cyber Terrorism • Reforming International Refugee Policies • Ensuring Global Food Security

The agenda reflects real-world international concerns and forms the foundation of all debate.

WHAT IS A PORTFOLIO?

A portfolio is the identity assigned to you in committee.

Your portfolio may be:

• A country. • A political leader. • An organization. • A ministry. • A stakeholder.

As a delegate, you must represent the views and interests of your assigned portfolio rather than your personal opinions.

WHAT IS THE EXECUTIVE BOARD (EB)?

The Executive Board is responsible for moderating and regulating committee proceedings.

The EB generally consists of:

• Chairperson • Vice Chairperson • Rapporteur

Responsibilities of the Executive Board

• Maintaining committee decorum. • Enforcing Rules of Procedure. • Moderating debates. • Evaluating delegates. • Facilitating productive discussion. • Assisting delegates throughout sessions.

Delegates are expected to maintain professionalism and respect toward the Executive Board at all times.

RULES OF PROCEDURE: ROLL CALL & MOTIONS

RULES OF PROCEDURE (ROP)

Rules of Procedure are the formal guidelines that govern committee functioning.

Understanding ROP is extremely important for every delegate because it determines how debates, speeches, motions, and voting procedures take place.

ROLL CALL

Every committee session begins with Roll Call.

During Roll Call, the Executive Board calls portfolios alphabetically, and delegates respond with either:

“Present”

A delegate who answers “Present” may vote: • Yes • No • Abstain

“Present and Voting”

A delegate who answers “Present and Voting”: • Must vote either Yes or No. • Cannot abstain.

A quorum must be established through Roll Call before formal debate can begin.

MOTIONS

Motions are formal proposals raised by delegates to change committee proceedings.

Examples of common motions include:

• Motion to Open Debate • Motion to Set the Agenda • Motion for Moderated Caucus • Motion for Unmoderated Caucus • Motion to Introduce Draft Resolution • Motion to Close Debate • Motion to Adjourn the Committee

Motions generally require committee approval through voting.

TYPES OF MOTIONS

IMPORTANT MOTIONS IN MUN:

Motion to Open Debate

This motion formally begins committee discussion on the agenda.

Motion to Set the Agenda

This motion determines which agenda topic will be discussed first.

Motion for a Moderated Caucus

This motion initiates a structured discussion on a specific sub-topic.

The motion must include: • Topic • Total Time • Individual Speaker's Time

Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

This motion temporarily suspends formal debate and allows delegates to freely negotiate, lobby, and collaborate.

The motion must include: • Total Duration

Motion to Introduce a Draft Resolution

This motion allows a written resolution to officially enter committee debate.

Motion to Close Debate

This motion ends debate on the agenda and moves committee into voting procedure.

Motion to Adjourn

This motion concludes the committee session until the next scheduled meeting.

Understanding motions is essential because they determine the flow and structure of committee proceedings.

FORMAL DEBATE IN MUN

UNDERSTANDING FORMAL DEBATE

Formal debate is the structured and official form of discussion conducted during committee proceedings. It allows delegates to present their country's perspective in a diplomatic, organized, and professional manner.

Formal debate is essential because it:

- Establishes the direction of committee discussion.
- Allows delegates to present research and policies.
- Encourages diplomatic exchange of ideas.
- Helps the Executive Board evaluate participation.
- Creates the foundation for resolutions and negotiations.

The two primary forms of formal debate are:

- General Speaker's List (GSL)
- Provisional Speaker's List (PSL)

During formal debate, delegates are expected to:

- Maintain diplomatic language.
- Speak respectfully toward all nations.
- Avoid personal attacks or informal expressions.
- Follow the Rules of Procedure carefully.
- Remain relevant to the agenda.

Formal debate reflects the professionalism of actual international diplomacy and therefore requires discipline, clarity, and composure.

GENERAL SPEAKER'S LIST (GSL)

The GSL is the primary platform through which delegates formally address the committee regarding the agenda under discussion.

During the GSL:

- Delegates deliver speeches on the agenda.
- Countries explain their official stance.
- Delegates discuss concerns and priorities.
- Possible solutions are introduced diplomatically.
- Nations respond to previous discussions.

The GSL generally remains active throughout committee sessions until debate is officially closed.

HOW DOES THE GSL FUNCTION?

At the beginning of committee, the Executive Board creates a speaker's list consisting of delegates who wish to speak.

Delegates are then recognized one by one by the Chairperson to deliver speeches within a fixed time limit.

The speaking time usually ranges between:

- 45 seconds
- 60 seconds
- 90 seconds
- 120 seconds

Depending upon committee format and Executive Board discretion.

THE OPENING SPEECH

The first speech delivered by a delegate on the GSL is known as the Opening Speech.

This speech is extremely important because it creates the committee's first impression of a delegate.

A strong opening speech generally includes:

- Brief introduction to the issue.
- The country's concerns regarding the agenda.
- Existing national policies.
- Diplomatic priorities.
- Broad proposed solutions.

Delegates are strongly advised to prepare their GSL speeches before the conference begins.

HOW TO DELIVER A STRONG GSL SPEECH

STRUCTURE OF A GOOD GSL SPEECH:

An effective GSL speech should be:

- Clear
- Diplomatic
- Organized
- Research-based
- Concise

A basic structure for a GSL speech may include:

Formal Introduction

Acknowledgement of the Agenda

Country's Concerns

Analysis of the Issue

Proposed Solutions

Diplomatic Conclusion

EXAMPLE OPENING LINE

“Honourable Executive Board, distinguished delegates, the Delegate of Germany believes that international cooperation remains essential in effectively combating cyber terrorism.”

IMPORTANT SPEAKING TIPS

Maintain Confidence

Even if you are nervous, speak calmly and clearly.

Use Diplomatic Language

Avoid aggressive or casual language.

Remain Relevant

Always connect your speech directly to the agenda.

Avoid Reading Excessively

Understand your content rather than memorizing every word.

Focus on Solutions

MUN values practical diplomacy more than criticism alone.

Maintain Proper Pace

Speak neither too fast nor too slowly.

COMMON MISTAKES MADE BY BEGINNERS

- Speaking in first person.
- Going off-topic.
- Speaking without structure.
- Excessive aggression.
- Overusing complicated vocabulary unnecessarily.
- Ignoring diplomacy while criticizing another country.

Remember: A good speech is not judged only by complexity, but by clarity, diplomacy, and substance.

PROVISIONAL SPEAKER'S LIST (PSL)

WHAT IS A PSL?

The Provisional Speaker's List (PSL) is a structured form of debate generally used to discuss procedural motions raised during committee.

Unlike the General Speaker's List, the PSL is not focused on the agenda broadly. Instead, delegates speak either for or against a particular motion.

During a PSL:

- Delegates provide arguments supporting a motion.
- Delegates explain objections against a motion.
- The Executive Board alternates speakers for balance.
- Procedural decisions are discussed diplomatically.

The Executive Board decides:

- Number of speakers.
- Individual speaker's time.
- Structure of the discussion.

PSLs are commonly used before entering:

- Moderated Caucuses
- Unmoderated Caucuses
- Voting procedures
- Closure of debate

Participating effectively in PSL discussions demonstrates procedural understanding, diplomacy, and strategic thinking.

YIELDS IN MUN

WHAT ARE YIELDS?

At the end of a speech, delegates may choose how to utilize their remaining time. This process is known as yielding.

Yields demonstrate confidence, diplomacy, and familiarity with committee procedure.

TYPES OF YIELDS

Yield to Executive Board:

The delegate gives the remaining time back to the Executive Board. This is the most commonly used yield by beginners.

Yield to Points of Information:

The delegate allows other delegates to ask questions regarding their speech.

This yield reflects confidence and strong preparation.

Yield to Another Delegate:

A delegate may transfer their remaining time to another delegate.

This is often used to:

- Strengthen alliances.
- Support bloc members.
- Continue a specific argument.

Delegates cannot yield more than once consecutively.

Strategic use of yields can significantly improve a delegate's visibility and diplomatic presence within committee.

MODERATED CAUCUS (MOD).

A Moderated Caucus is a structured discussion on a specific sub-topic under the agenda.

When a Moderated Caucus begins:

- The committee temporarily leaves the General Speaker's List.
- Delegates speak specifically on the chosen topic.
- The Executive Board recognizes speakers individually.

Moderated Caucuses encourage focused discussion and rapid participation.

A Motion for Moderated Caucus must include:

- Topic of discussion.
- Total duration.
- Individual speaker's time.

Example:

“The Delegate of France would like to raise a motion to suspend formal debate and move into a Moderated Caucus on the topic of refugee rehabilitation for a total time of 10 minutes, with individual speaker's time being 45 seconds.”

Moderated Caucuses are extremely important because they allow delegates to showcase research, diplomacy, and analytical thinking effectively.

UNMODERATED CAUCUS (UNMOD)

An Unmoderated Caucus is an informal committee session where delegates freely interact with one another without formal speaking procedure.

During an Unmoderated Caucus:

- Delegates may move freely around committee.
- Alliances and blocs are formed.
- Negotiations take place.
- Draft resolutions are discussed and prepared.

Unlike formal debate, the Executive Board does not recognize speakers individually during an Unmoderated Caucus.

A Motion for Unmoderated Caucus must include:

- Total duration of the caucus.

These caucuses are extremely important because they allow practical diplomacy and collaboration between delegates.

Most working papers and draft resolutions are developed during Unmoderated Caucuses through lobbying and negotiation.

POINTS IN MUN

WHAT ARE POINTS?

Points are procedural interruptions raised by delegates to address matters outside substantive debate.

Points help maintain smooth and fair committee functioning.

COMMON TYPES OF POINTS

Point of Personal Privilege

Raised when a delegate experiences personal discomfort such as inability to hear the speaker or technical issues.

This is the only point allowed to interrupt a speaker.

Point of Information

Raised to ask questions regarding another delegate's speech.

Point of Order

Raised when a delegate believes there has been a procedural mistake or factual inaccuracy.

Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

Raised when a delegate has doubts regarding Rules of Procedure or committee functioning.

Right of Reply

Raised when a delegate believes their country's sovereignty or integrity has been insulted.

Points should always be raised respectfully and only when genuinely necessary.

CHITS & COMMUNICATION

CHITS IN MUN

Chits are written forms of communication used during committee proceedings.

They are important tools for:

- Diplomacy
- Negotiation
- Research sharing
- Alliance building

TYPES OF CHITS

Substantive Chit

Sent to the Executive Board to share research, solutions, policy suggestions, or important analytical points.

Via-EB Chit

Sent to another delegate through the Executive Board for formal diplomatic communication.

Delegate-to-Delegate Chit

Informal communication directly between delegates for lobbying and negotiation purposes.

IMPORTANCE OF CHITS

Effective chit communication allows delegates to:

- Build alliances.
- Coordinate resolutions.
- Share important information.
- Remain active even without speaking frequently.

Professional and diplomatic communication through chits is an important aspect of committee participation.

DOCUMENTATION IN MUN

IMPORTANCE OF DOCUMENTATION

Documentation is one of the most important aspects of Model United Nations.

While speeches demonstrate verbal ability, documentation reflects:

- Research capability
- Policy understanding
- Diplomatic drafting skills
- Structured analytical thinking

COMMON TYPES OF DOCUMENTS:

- Position Paper
- Press Release
- Working Paper
- Bilateral Agreement
- Multilateral Agreement
- Report
- Statement
- Communiqué
- Draft Resolution

POSITION PAPER

A Position Paper explains:

- Background of the agenda.
- Country stance and policies.
- Past actions taken.
- Proposed diplomatic solutions.

WORKING PAPER

A Working Paper is an informal document containing preliminary ideas, proposed solutions, and collaborative suggestions discussed by delegates during committee proceedings.

Working papers are generally used to:

- Organize bloc discussions.
- Combine policy ideas.
- Draft possible solutions.
- Build consensus among delegates.

Working papers are not final documents and may continue evolving throughout committee discussions.

DRAFT RESOLUTION

A Draft Resolution is the final formal document containing the collective solutions proposed by delegates regarding the agenda. It represents the committee's attempt to solve the issue diplomatically and practically.

A Draft Resolution generally contains:

- Sponsors
- Signatories
- Preambulatory Clauses
- Operative Clauses

Sponsors are delegates who actively contributed to writing the resolution.

Signatories are delegates who support discussing the resolution in committee.

A strong Draft Resolution should always remain:

- Realistic
- Diplomatic
- Structured
- Solution-oriented

CLAUSES & AMENDMENTS

PREAMBULATORY CLAUSES

Preambulatory clauses provide background information and context regarding the issue discussed in the resolution.

These clauses explain:

- Previous international actions.
- Concerns regarding the agenda.
- Existing global situations.
- Principles and frameworks involved.

Examples of preambulatory phrases include:

- Acknowledging
- Alarmed by
- Deeply concerned
- Reaffirming
- Recognizing
- Stressing

OPERATIVE CLAUSES

Operative clauses contain the actual solutions and actions proposed by the committee.

These clauses explain:

- What actions should be taken.
- Which organizations will act.
- How solutions will be implemented.

Examples of operative phrases include:

- Calls upon
- Encourages
- Requests
- Urges
- Decides
- Supports

AMENDMENTS

Amendments are changes proposed to operative clauses within a Draft Resolution.

There are two types of amendments:

- Friendly Amendments
- Unfriendly Amendments

Friendly Amendments are supported by all sponsors of the resolution.

Unfriendly Amendments require committee voting because not all sponsors agree with the proposed change.

VOTING PROCEDURE

Voting procedure begins once debate on the agenda has officially concluded.

During voting procedure:

- The committee becomes highly formal.
- Delegates generally cannot leave the room.
- Interruptions are minimized.
- Draft resolutions and amendments are voted upon.

TYPES OF VOTES

Delegates who answered Roll Call with:

“Present”

May vote:

- Yes, No or Abstain from voting.

Delegates who answered:

“Present and Voting”

Must vote either:

- Yes or No

Abstentions are not allowed in this case.

HOW TO PREPARE BEFORE COMMITTEE?

IMPORTANT AREAS OF PREPARATION

Research Your Portfolio

Understand:

- Foreign policy of your country.
- International alliances.
- Country stance on the agenda.
- Past actions and treaties.

Research the Agenda Thoroughly

Study:

- Causes of the issue.
- Current global situation.
- Previous UN actions.
- Possible diplomatic solutions.
- The Rules of Procedure

Understanding committee procedure helps delegates:

- Speak confidently.
- Raise motions properly.
- Participate effectively in debate.

Prepare Your GSL Speech

Delegates are strongly advised to prepare their opening speech before committee begins.

Practice Public Speaking

Confidence improves significantly through regular speaking practice and preparation.

Strong preparation often determines the overall quality of participation during committee sessions.

CREDIBLE SOURCES FOR RESEARCH

Delegates should always rely on professional and trustworthy sources while researching.

Recommended sources include:

- Official United Nations websites.
- UN resolutions and archives.
- Government websites and ministries.
- International organizations such as WHO, UNESCO, IMF, and IAEA.
- Reuters and other credible international news platforms.

Avoid relying on unverified or unreliable information sources.

FINAL MESSAGE TO DELEGATES

Model United Nations is much more than a competition.

It is a platform that develops:

- Leadership
- Confidence
- Diplomacy
- Negotiation skills
- Global awareness
- Critical thinking

At PYFMUN 2026, delegates are encouraged not only to compete, but also to learn, collaborate, and grow through meaningful diplomatic engagement.

Do not fear making mistakes during committee.

Every experienced delegate once began as a beginner.

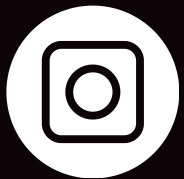
Speak confidently, research thoroughly, remain diplomatic, and most importantly; enjoy the experience of international dialogue and cooperation.

We look forward to witnessing your diplomacy at PYFMUN 2026.

Thank You
&
Best of Luck for the
Conference



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